look at his instrument. They returned, impressed. Chandrasekhar approved the paper for publication.

Jesse Greenstein, who had become an astronomer at Yerkes after completing his Harvard graduate studies, made a number of trips down to Wheaton over the next few years and became a close friend of Reber's. Greenstein describes Reber as "the ideal American inventor. If he had not been interested in radio astronomy, he would have made a million dollars."

Enthusiastic about Reber's research, Greenstein tried, after a few years, to move him to the University of Chicago. "The University didn't want to spend a dime on radio astronomy," Greenstein recalls. But Otto Struve, the director of the University's Yerkes Observatory, agreed to a research appointment provided the money to pay Reber and support his research came from Washington. Reber, however, "was an independent cuss," Greenstein says. He refused to explain to the bureaucrats in any detail how the money for new telescopes would be spent. The deal fell through.

In the meantime, World War II had ended, and scientists who had done technical work in the war effort were looking for new challenges. Among them were experimental physicists who had developed radar for tracking enemy aircraft during the war. Since radar is nothing but radio waves that are sent out from a radio-telescope-like transmitter, bounce off an airplane, and return back to the transmitter, these experimental physicists were ideally poised to give life to the new field of radio astronomy—and some of them were eager to do so; the technical challenges were great, and the intellectual payoffs promising. Of the many who tried their hand at it, three teams quickly came to dominate the field: Bernard Lovell's team at Jodrell Bank/Manchester University in England; Martin Ryle's team at Cambridge University in England; and a team put together by J. L. Pawsey and John Bolton in Australia. In America there was little effort of note; Grote Reber continued his radio astronomy research virtually alone.

Optical astronomers (astronomers who study the sky with light,[1] the only kind of astronomer that existed in those days) paid little attention to the experimental physicists' feverish activity. They would remain uninterested until radio telescopes could measure a source's position on the sky accurately enough to determine which light-emitting object was responsible for the radio waves. This would require a 100-fold improvement in resolution over that achieved by Reber, that is, a 100-fold